Speaking

Teacher's notes

Task 1: Students A and B

Both students are looking at a number of photos.

Prompt: Work in pairs. I'm going to describe a situation to you. Imagine that you are going on a long journey by train. Look at the photos of things that could be useful on this journey. Talk together about the different things, and say which things would be most useful. Here are some pictures with some ideas to help you.

Give students photo sheet.

Prompt: All right? Talk together.

Task 2

Student A

Each student is looking at a different photo.

Prompt: Now I'd like each of you to talk on your own about something. I'm going to give each of you a photo about mobile phones. Student A, here is your photograph. Please show it to Student B, but I'd like you to talk about it. Student B, you listen. Student A, please tell us what you can see in the photograph.

Give Student A Photo A.

Student B

Each student is looking at a different photo.

Prompt: Student B, here is your photograph. It shows somebody with a mobile phone. Please show it to Student A, but I'd like you to talk about it. Student A, you listen. Student B, please tell us what you can see in the photograph.

Give Student B Photo B.

Sample answers and mark schemes

Task 1

Can express opinions and attitudes in a simple way.

Student A and B dialogue

A So let's have a look at the pictures ... things that might be useful on a long journey. Well, personally, I always have to take some food and drink! It's always expensive to buy at the station. How about you?

B Yes, I agree, and sometimes the snack bars are shut and you can't buy anything. So those are very useful.

A And sometimes I've travelled by train on a long journey and it was really cold. I needed a blanket, but I didn't have one.

B You're right – but it's difficult to carry all these things, isn't it? I think the pillow is a great idea, too, but you would need a big bag!

A That's true – but sometimes if you're on a plane, the flight attendants give you these things for free – and that's wonderful!

B Yes it is – if you like flying! But we're travelling by train. I always get really bored on long journeys, so I need something to do. I think magazines are good.

A Yes, you can recycle them when you've read them. For me, the most useful thing is the tablet. I've downloaded books and music onto mine, and it's great.

B Yes, it is. The problem is, I can't always get the Internet on mine, so I can't surf the web or check my emails. But if you've downloaded stuff, a tablet's really useful.

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Speaking

The task is worth 10 marks. Award up to 2 marks for each section of the mark scheme, according to the descriptions below.

Marks	Task achievement	Spoken production and fluency	Spoken interaction	Range	Accuracy
0–1	Describes some aspects of the photos but doesn't really mention what is useful or not. Doesn't fully answer the task question.	Hesitates a lot and does not seem confident. Is not easy to understand.	Does not engage with the listener.	Uses only very basic vocabulary and grammar, with a lot of errors.	Lots of errors even in basic language, which impede communication.
1.5	Describes the photos and mentions what is useful or not. Gives an opinion and answers the task question.	Speaks with some confidence and is comprehensible. Some hesitation, but not enough to impede communication.	Engages with the listener to some extent, and makes an effort to communicate effectively.	Uses simple vocabulary and basic grammar structures accurately. Uses some more advanced vocabulary and grammar structures with errors.	Generally accurate, but with some errors, especially in more advanced language.
2	Describes the photos in detail and talks about what is useful or not. Uses the photos to speculate and give opinions. Answers the task question in detail.	Speaks with fluency, with very little hesitation. Is clear and comprehensible. Uses some intonation to add emphasis.	Engages fully with the listener, using gestures to help express meaning.	Uses a wide range of vocabulary appropriately, and uses a wide range of grammar structures accurately and appropriately.	A few mistakes in more advanced language structures, but generally very accurate.

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Task 2

Can give or seek personal views and opinions in discussing topics of interest.

Student A

Well, my photo shows a smartphone, and on the screen there's a map. It looks like the map of city streets. There's a route marked on it in colour. I guess this is showing the person using it how to get from one place to another. It's a very useful thing to have on your mobile if you get lost and you don't have a map. I've never used it on my phone, though! I'm not really sure how to and anyway, I know my way around my town really well. I tend to use my mobile for making calls to people or taking photos and things like that.

Student B

Let's see – my photo shows someone holding a mobile phone – a smartphone – and on the screen there's some writing. It looks like the page of a newspaper or something, so I guess they're on the Internet and they're reading the daily newspaper. That's really useful and it can be cheaper because sometimes you don't have to pay. It's free! I don't read the newspaper like this, though. The screen's too small for me, and I prefer to have a paper newspaper to read and look at the photos! It's easier to just look through the pages and see what's interesting.

The task is worth 10 marks. Award up to 2 marks for each section of the mark scheme, according to the descriptions below.

Marks	Task achievement	Spoken production and fluency	Spoken interaction	Range	Accuracy
0–1	Gives only short answers. Doesn't develop ideas and doesn't express opinions.	Hesitates a lot and does not seem confident. Is not easy to understand.	n/a	Uses only very basic vocabulary and grammar, with a lot of errors.	Lots of errors even in basic language, which impede communication.
1.5	Gives clear answers and develops some ideas with examples. Gives opinions.	Speaks with some confidence and is comprehensible. Some hesitation, but not enough to impede communication.	n/a	Uses simple vocabulary and basic grammar structures accurately. Uses some more advanced vocabulary and grammar structures with errors.	Generally accurate, but with some errors, especially in more advanced language.
2	Gives very full answers, developing ideas, expanding through examples and expressing a range of opinions.	Speaks with fluency, with very little hesitation. Is clear and comprehensible. Uses some intonation to add emphasis.	n/a	Uses a wide range of vocabulary appropriately, and uses a wide range of grammar structures accurately and appropriately.	A few mistakes in more advanced language structures, but generally very accurate.

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